

November 17, 2025

CITY OF CONWAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING
CONWAY CITY HALL
229 MAIN STREET, CONWAY
MONDAY, NOVEMBER 17, 2025

PRESENT: Mayor Barbara Jo Blain, Mayor Pro Tem William Goldfinch, Amanda Butler, Julie Hardwick, Beth Helms, Justin Jordan and Larry White.

STAFF: Adam Emrick, City Administrator; Mary Catherine Hyman, Deputy City Administrator; John Rogers, Deputy City Administrator; June Wood, Public Information Officer; Jeff Leveille, Technology Services Director; Jason Perzan, Deputy Fire Chief; Reggie Jenerette, Solid Waste Director; Robert Cooper, Construction Services Director; Becky Graham, Human Resource Deputy Director; Ted Dudley, Public Utilities Director; Jessica Hucks, Planning and Development Director; Braxton Fleming, Public Works Deputy Director; Dale Long, Police Chief; Allison Williams, Finance Director; Timmy Williams, Hospitality and Beautification Director; Kayla Fleming, Municipal Judge; Ashley Smith, Recreation Director; Kelly Thomas, Deputy PIO; David Crotts, Procurement and Inventory Division Chief; Rosanne Date, Grants and Special Projects Division Chief; and Alicia Shelley, City Clerk.

OTHERS: There were approximately 50 others in attendance.

CALL TO ORDER: Mayor Blain called the meeting to order. Blain welcomed the Coastal LIFE students in attendance.

INVOCATION/PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE: White gave the invocation and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

The requirements for posting notice of this meeting under South Carolina's Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) were met.

CONSENT AGENDA:

- A. Approval of a Resolution Honoring Coach James Pinckney for his service to the Conway Parks and Recreation Department.**
- B. Approval of a Request from applicant, Drew McElveen, to certify the property at 1311 Ninth Avenue (PIN 338-14-03-0042) as an eligible property for a special tax assessment under the Preservation Tax Incentive Program.**
- C. Approval of Intergovernmental Agreement between the City of Conway and Horry County for the Development of the Horry County Master Trail Plan.**
- D. Approval of November 3, 2025 Council Meeting Minutes**

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APPROVAL OF CONSENT AGENDA: **Motion:** Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Butler to approve the November 17, 2025 consent agenda. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

SPECIAL PRESENTATION:

- A. Presentation of a Proclamation Recognizing Pancreatic Cancer Day** – Blain read the Proclamation recognizing Pancreatic Cancer Day on November 20, 2025.
- B. Presentation of a Resolution Honoring Coach James Pinckney for his service to the Conway Parks and Recreation Department** – Blain presented James Pinckney, while surrounded by his family and friends, a Resolution in honor of his 30 years of service to the Conway Parks and Recreation Department.
- C. Presentation of Employee of the Month for November 2025 – Public Works** – Dudley presented Jamie Givens in the Public Utilities Department with the November 2025 Employee of the Month award.

FIRST READING:

- A. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2025-12-01 (C) to rezone approximately 0.39+/- acres of property located at 4 Clemson Road (PIN 383-15-02-0010), from the Horry County Residential, no mobile homes allowed (SF-10) district to the City of Conway Low/ Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district upon annexation.** Hucks stated that council approved first reading of the annexation of this property at their October 6 meeting. This property is within the Coastal Heights subdivision, at the corner of Singleton Ridge Road. Several lots within this subdivision have been annexed over the years because of the existing homes being sold and new accounts having to be set up to receive utility services. The city's future land use map identifies the property as R-1. Planning Commission held a public hearing on the request at their November 6 meeting and recommended approval. Hucks said that staff also recommended approval of the proposed zoning to R-1 upon annexation.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Helms, to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2025-12-01 (C) rezoning the property located at 4 Clemson Road to R-1.

Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

- B. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2025-12-01 (D) to rezone approximately 0.35+/- acres of property located at 1328 Cottage Lane and 1636 Church Street (PINs 338-10-2-0009 & 338-10-02-0008), from the City of Conway Low/ Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.** Hucks stated that this is a request to rezone two parcels located at the corner of Church Street and Cottage Lane. Both parcels are currently zoned R-1. One of the parcels is where a title loan business had been located for several years and the other parcel is vacant, except for a billboard. The city's future land use map identifies the properties as HC and the requested zoning is also HC, for purposes of commercial development. Planning Commission held a public hearing

and recommended approval to rezone the properties to HC. Hucks said that staff also recommends approval to rezone both parcels to HC.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Jordan, to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2025-12-01 (D) rezoning the properties located at 1328 Cottage Lane and 1636 Church Street to HC. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- C. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (C) to annex approximately 0.4+/- acres of property located at 5007 Presbyterian Drive (PIN 383-08-02-0010).** Hucks stated that this property is within the College Park subdivision, and annexation is now being required due to a change of name in ownership of the property, in accordance with restrictive covenants that were recorded in 1998 as well as a condition of receiving city utilities. The property contains a single-family dwelling. Several other properties have been annexed over the last several years, with the adjacent parcel annexed in 2007, with sixteen other properties within College Park annexed as R-1. The applicant did not disclose whether the residence was owner-occupied or a rental, however, the property owner's legal residence is a different address from this property. If first reading of this annexation is approved, Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the request at their December 11 meeting. Hucks said that staff recommended first reading of this ordinance to annex the property.

Motion: Hardwick made a motion, seconded by Butler, to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (C) annexing the property at 5007 Presbyterian Drive. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- D. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (D) to annex approximately 16.6+/- acres of property located on Ole Alston Ave (PIN 369-00-00-0031).** Hucks stated that this property is currently vacant, but annexation is being requested in accordance with the city's requirements to connect to city utilities, as there is likely pending development of this property. There have been two previous requests for annexation on Ole Alston Avenue since 2022, both of which were disapproved by Council due to the condition of the roadway. The existing roadway is an unimproved county road which dead ends shortly past this property, so there would not be an appropriate location for sanitation or emergency vehicles to turn around, nor does the road meet the minimum city standards for roadways. Hucks said that for this reason, and because previous requests for annexation were denied, staff recommended disapproval.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms, to disapprove Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (D) for annexation of the property located on Ole Alston Avenue. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- E. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (E) to annex approximately 0.37+/- acres of property located at 801 Donald Street (PIN 369-12-04-0002).** Hucks stated that annexation of this property is being requested due to a change in ownership of the property and a new utility account in the name of the property's personal representative, according to Probate documentation that was submitted in conjunction with the

annexation. There have been restrictive covenants on file for this property since 1987. The property contains a single-family residence. There have been eleven other properties in the neighborhood that have been annexed, with the neighboring property annexed in 2023. Should first reading of the annexation be approved, Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the proposed zoning of the property at their December 11 meeting. Hucks said that staff recommended approval of first reading to annex this parcel.

Motion: Jordan made a motion, seconded by Hardwick, to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (E) annexing the property at 801 Donald Street. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

F. First Reading of Ordinance #2025-12-01 (E) amending the Business License Ordinance of the City of Conway to update the Class Schedule as required by Act 176 of 2020. Rogers stated that this is a housekeeping item and that state law requires that by December 31 of each year, all cities collecting business license revenue under the state's Standardization Act, must update their business license ordinance to reflect updates as recommended by the Municipal Association of South Carolina.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Goldfinch, to approve first reading of Ordinance #2025-12-01 (E) amending the Business License Ordinance to update the Class Schedule **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

CONSIDERATION:

Consideration of Award of 2025-26 Economic Development Grant – Rogers stated that on April 8 the city launched its sixth annual Economic Development Grant program to support local growth through innovative programs, events, and vendors. Applications closed May 12 with \$150,000 available. On June 16 Council awarded \$107,530 across three recipients, leaving \$42,470 remaining. Coastal Carolina University has requested \$42,000 to support its Banana Ball event, a two-day program scheduled for March 28-29, 2026 at Spring Brooks Stadium, in partnership with the City of Conway. Rogers said that staff recommended partnering with CCU for the Banana Ball event in the amount of \$42,000.

Motion: Helms made a motion, seconded by Blain, to approve staff's recommendation.

Goldfinch had concerns with the funds coming from the general fund and asked staff to find the money in hospitality funds. Emrick said that staff would find the amount in the hospitality funds account.

Amended Motion: Helms amended her motion, seconded by Blain, to approve the requested funding from hospitality funds for CCU's Banana Ball event. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

PUBLIC INPUT:

- Jimmy Hammond spoke to council regarding the retiree's health insurance.

CITY ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT:

Emrick informed Council of the following:

- Commended BooJangles on Church Street in October. In the last few days, they have been rolling out BoJingles, their Christmas version of BooJangles. This BoJangles was the #1 BoJangles store in the state during October. It was the #8 store in the chain nationwide out of nearly 1000 stores. Felicia Tracy, the general manager of Conway's BoJangles, tied for the crown of "best of the best" GMs in this year's competition.
- Invited all to drop in for Chief Hendrick's Retirement tomorrow from 1 – 3 p.m. at 196 Laurel Street.
- The ribbon cutting for the new mural beside Stella's Ice Cream is Wednesday at 2 p.m. Special thanks to Conway Downtown Alive and Coastal Carolina University for another fantastic collaboration and colorful addition to our downtown.
- Thanksgiving is next week, and staff will decorate the city Christmas tree after the Thanksgiving holiday is over, just in time for the city's big Christmas Tree Lighting festivities on December 4. Staff have begun sharing the message that Main Street will be closed for a large portion of the day.
- The Christmas Carnival will be back this year, bigger and better than last year. With the acquisition of the former steam plant site from Santee Cooper, our Recreation Department has added additional length to the Celebration of Lights. Elves from all departments have been cobbling away at bringing a bigger, brighter Christmas than ever before to Conway.
- At the next Council meeting, the second and final reading of the creation of the city's TIF District will be held. The School Board is meeting tonight as well, and John Rogers and Gary Pope, attorney, will be attending to answer any questions about the TIF.
- There are two workshop items tonight, a discussion of private fire hydrant maintenance responsibilities and the potential naming of a field at the Sports and Fitness Center; and multiple Executive Session items.
- Next is a report from Ted Dudley from our Public Utilities Department.

White recommended a proclamation be given to BoJangles for their participation in Halloween and Christmas. Emrick said staff would prepare after Christmas.

White suggested that the Christmas tree lighting be moved over where the haunted house was located. Emrick said that the carnival would be set up in that location again this year.

Blain mentioned that water testing companies are going door to door. Emrick responded with the following: (A) The city has had reports over the years of various companies going door to door. Some present themselves in a way so as to confuse residents that they represent the city. Some are less dubious, but no less illegal. Door-to-door sales are illegal in the City of Conway. If someone comes to your door trying to sell something, they've already broken the law. Call the police and report it and do not buy anything from them. (B) The city's water is purchased from Grand Strand Water and Sewer Authority. It is tested and approved by a variety of state and federal government agencies. There's nothing wrong with getting your water tested, with buying fancy filtration systems. They may make your clean water even cleaner. Emrick said he recommends doing research on your own and going from there. (C) Prior to the meeting

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tonight, the city police department reached out to one of the companies that is actively going door to door, advising them that they are breaking the law. If we can catch them actively in the process of doing so, we can act more aggressively in helping end this practice.

Dudley gave Council a yearly update on the Public Utilities Department.

COUNCIL INPUT:

Helms

- Thanked staff for everything.
- Said that she is looking forward to Christmas and volunteering.

Butler

- Asked that at the Tree Lighting Ceremony will the deaf and others with disabilities have a certain area to go and will an interpreter be there. Emrick said that an interpreter will attend and staff will try to make accommodations on the Main Street side of the stage and put the message out through public messaging.
- Said that she received a letter from a resident asking that the city plant more native plants and pollinators downtown.

White

- Asked to plant more native around town, not just downtown.

Goldfinch

- Said that he heard the Athletic Director at Conway High School speak and later learned that there was a change in leadership at the school however even though Conway High School is not the city's wheelhouse but the success of any high school program in a small town is key as it builds moral. Goldfinch thinks if council can support the school that the city can reap the reward and benefits as people looking to move here look at the schools. Goldfinch said if the city can support them then he thinks it will go a long way in the quality of life for those in Conway.

Jordan

- Thanked the 4 candidates that ran for city council for running a clean campaign.
- Asked staff to publicize more leading up to the city election and also following the election to post the results.

Hardwick

- Said that she agreed with Goldfinch in that council needs to look at all the schools in Conway to be more energized.
- Commended the candidates saying that they all did a great job.
- Talked about giving \$42,000 to Savannah Bananas and said that it will bring more people into Conway. She then read their 2026 schedule announcing much larger towns that they will be in. Hardwick said that she knows we are spending hospitality tax money very wisely and that this is an investment that will benefit Coastal and the City of Conway.
- Thanked staff for everything.

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Blain

- Said that she is proud to be part of Conway.

WORKSHOP:

Private Fire Hydrant Maintenance Responsibility – Dudley explained to Council that the city has been maintaining private fire hydrants for years, which is costly and has lots of liabilities on the city. Dudley recommends that staff send out letters to these private companies saying that the city will no longer maintain these private fire hydrants.

There was some discussion regarding fire extinguishers versus fire hydrants and who is responsible. Parker and Perzan stated that the Fire Department would be responsible for making sure that they are complaint, but the private owner would bear the maintenance and expenses.

Dudley said he thinks there are approximately 50-60 private fire hydrants that are commercial related, not residential.

Council gave staff the go ahead with getting a letter prepared to send out to the private fire hydrant owners regarding this matter.

Changing of Field 2 Name at the Recreation Department to James Pickney – Smith told council that the the Recreation Department tries to recognize students and athletes. He said that naming of the fields is one way and he gave examples, Billy Gardner, Pete Wilkes and Ken Senn. Smith now recommends naming Field 2 to the James Pinckney Field.

Council approved staff to move forward with the naming of Field 2.

EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Jordan, to enter into Executive Session for the following: **(A) Discussion on Contractual Matters Incident to Retirees Health Insurance [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]; (B) Discussion of Employment of an Employee in the Fire Department [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (1)]; (C) Discussion of Employment of an Employee in the Fleet Maintenance Department [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (1)]; (D) Discussion of an Economic Development Opportunity named Project Smokestacks [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (5)]; and (E) Discussion regarding Potential Acquisition of Property [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]**

RECONVENE FROM EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Jordan to leave Executive Session. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

POSSIBLE ACTION ON MATTERS DISCUSSED IN EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Blain authorizing the administrator to purchase tax sale property. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

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ADJOURNMENT: **Motion:** Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Hardwick, to adjourn the meeting. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES: Minutes approved by City Council this 1 day of December, 2025.


Alicia Shelley, City Clerk